where r is the resistance per unit length of wire.

$$\frac{P}{Q} = \frac{AJ}{JB} = \frac{l_1}{l_2} \quad (2.55)$$

$$P = Q\frac{l_1}{l_2} \quad (2.56)$$

The bridge wire is soldered at the ends of the copper strips. Due to imperfect contact, some resistance might be introduced at the contact. These are called end resistances. This error can be eliminated, if another set of readings is taken with P and Q interchanged and the average value of P is found.

To find the specific resistance of the material of the wire in the coil P, the radius a and length l of the wire are measured. The specific resistance or resistivity ρ can be calculated using the relation.

$$\text{Resistance} = \rho\frac{l}{A}$$

By rearranging the above equation, we get

$$\rho = \text{Resistance} \times \frac{A}{l} \quad (2.57)$$

If P is the unknown resistance equation (2.57) becomes,

$$\rho = P\frac{\pi a^2}{l}$$

EXAMPLE 2.25

In a meter bridge experiment with a standard resistance of 15 Ω in the right gap, the ratio of balancing length is 3:2. Find the value of the other resistance.

Solution

$Q = 15\ \Omega, \quad l_1 : l_2 = 3:2$

$$\frac{l_1}{l_2} = \frac{3}{2}$$

$$\frac{P}{Q} = \frac{l_1}{l_2}$$

$$P = Q\,\frac{l_1}{l_2}$$

$$P = 15 \times \frac{3}{2} = 22.5\ \Omega$$

EXAMPLE 2.26

In a meter bridge experiment, the value of resistance in the resistance box connected in the right gap is 10 Ω. The balancing length is l_1 = 55 cm. Find the value of unknown resistance.

Solution

$Q = 10\ \Omega$

$$\frac{P}{Q} = \frac{l_1}{100 - l_1} = \frac{l_1}{l_2}$$

$$P = Q \times \frac{l_1}{100 - l_1}$$

$$P = \frac{10 \times 55}{100 - 55}$$

$$P = \frac{550}{45} = 12.2\ \Omega$$

2.5.5 Potentiometer

Potentiometer is used for the accurate measurement of potential differences, current and resistances. It consists of ten meter long uniform wire of manganin or constantan stretched in parallel rows each of 1 meter length, on a wooden board. The two free ends A and B are brought to the same side and fixed to copper strips with binding screws. A meter scale is fixed parallel to the wire. A jockey is provided for making contact.

The principle of the potentiometer is illustrated in Figure 2.27. A steady current is maintained across the wire CD by a battery Bt.

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